



speech absolutist who'll allow even the most vile things to exist on Twitter because that's what the tenets of free speech actually call for. That is simply not true, and Elon Musk has clarified his stance publicly. "By "free speech", I simply mean that which matches the law. I am against censorship that goes far beyond the law. If people want less free speech, they will ask the government to pass laws to that effect. Therefore, going beyond the law is contrary to the will of the people", said Elon in a Tweet right after the Twitter Board had accepted his offer to acquire Twitter for USD 44 billion.

PUBLIC TO PRIVATE

A good chunk of the arguments being made revolve around accountability and the fact that being a publicly-traded company immediately makes the company accountable to the people because they own the company and the stockholders and company officials are bound by their fiduciary duties to serve the people. Yes, fiduciary duty is legality that prevents the board of any company to run amok and indulge their own silly whims. It makes them accountable and responsible to answer the stockholders. But has anyone actually looked at Twitter's stock ownership?

As of writing this, 40.95 per cent of Twitter stock is owned by Mutual Fund holders, 35.92 per cent is owned by other Institutional holders and Individual stakeholders only form 12.48 per cent of the total. And who owned Twitter before Elon Musk

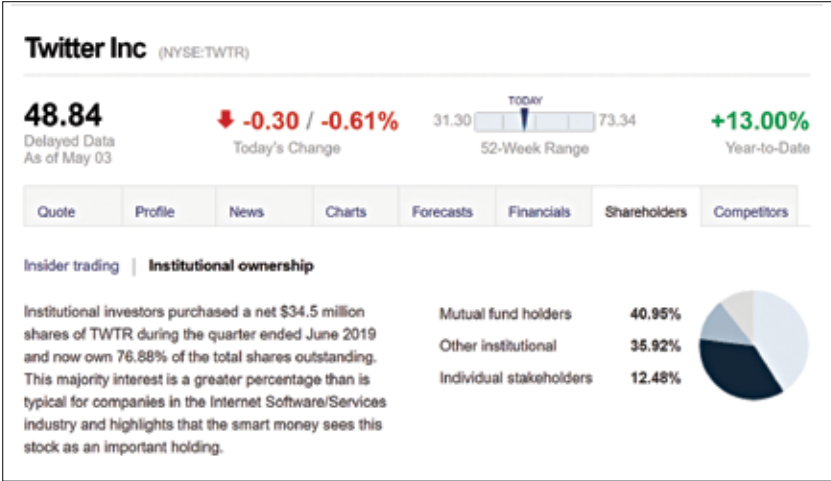
twitter's (mostly) going to be the same

Elon Musk buying Twitter isn't as bad as it's made out to be

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all the hullabaloo over Twitter going private with Elon Musk taking over the reins is rather overexaggerated. Twitter, which is referred to as the "Town Square" of the internet, is seen as an open platform where the future of humanity is discussed and debated. Or so, you're led to think. A town square is supposed to be a neutral place where anyone and everyone can voice their opinions and engage in a healthy debate. Twitter has about 229 million daily active users at the moment, so it's nowhere close to being a town square. It's funny if you believe that it is an open platform, open to all. Most tech platforms are heavily biased toward one side of the political spectrum or the other and their content moderation policies, many of which are rigidly opaque, exist to reinforce a particular side of the story.

Elon Musk wants to change that. The billionaire owner of Tesla and SpaceX wants to make Twitter into an open platform where biases don't exist and the people are genuinely free to speak their minds. A lot has been written to make him sound like a free-



Twitter's stock ownership

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